b) Insufficiency in production due to the traditional agricultural practice which was primitive in use of technology.

c) The pattern of agriculture was not only very primitive but farmers relied on long term crop patterns which took long time to see the results.

d) Since India is a monsoon dependent state the agricultural output was dependent on the nature of rainfall, insufficient rain fall resulted in drought which affected the grain production in India leading to famine, starvation and deaths.

During 1960's a New Agriculture Policy was formulated on the basis of suggestions given by the Ford Foundation. In its report 'India's Crisis of Food and Steps to Meet it' the Ford Foundation's agricultural experts suggested certain reforms. The Government of India introduced the reforms in agriculture. These reforms were adopted as a collective programme in order to bring existing and new irrigation facilities, application of fertilizers, hybrid seeds that can bring high yield, pesticides, insecticides etc.. This new way was gradually adopted in Indian agriculture. This was called GREEN REVOLUTION. The plan for Green Revolution was formulated by the notable Indian agriculture scientist Dr. M.S. Swaminathan who was later known as Father of India's Green Revolution. In simple terms, the increased use of fertilizers and irrigation are known collectively as the Indian Green Revolution. The Green Revolution took place between 1967-78 which resulted in 50% increase in agricultural production.

In 1960, seven districts in seven states were selected by the Indian Government for a pilot project known as Intensive Area Development Programme (IADP). As the results were far more satisfactory, the reform programme was extended to other States. Hence, this programme was extended to remaining states and one district from each state was selected for intensive development. Subsequently it was extended to 144 districts in 1965.

In the initial stage, this programme was implemented around 2 million hectares of area. Gradually the coverage of the programme was enlarged and total area covered by this Green Revolution programme was estimated as 70 million hectares which accounted to 40% of the agricultural cover. Consequently, farming activities began to take throughout the year, that is, from single cropping pattern to multiples of cropping and mixed cropping, which meant not just the cultivation of wheat or rice alone as in the traditional farming pattern. Due to the geo-climate variations in different parts of India, farmers in India adopted different types of cropping pattern. Northern States of India like Punjab, Haryana and Uttar Pradesh quickly found better results with regard to wheat, while Southern states like Karnataka, Tamil Nadu etc found lesser rate of success in regard to cultivation of rice. However, the over all result in the long run was more impressive to alleviate food shortage.

Major impacts of Green Revolution

❖ Substantial Increase in Agricultural Production

Volume of agricultural outcome increased by two to three fold compared to the period in 1950's. The increased production of rice, wheat, cereals and vegetables had erased the humiliation that India had to import grains from the United States during the PL-480 programme in 1950's. Moreover the agricultural goods were freely available to the people in the open market.

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